



The SECAS Third Thursday Web Forum

Make your voice heard: Ensuring SECAS stays focused on what matters most

6-18-2026



Agenda

- Introduction
- Interactive presentation and discussion
- Preview of next webinar



Make your voice heard: Ensuring SECAS stays focused on what matters most

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6-18-2026



Recent disruptions yield new tradeoffs

- Disruptions over the last year include:
 - Loss of 50% of capacity
 - Extended government shutdown
 - Changes in travel policy that make it difficult to attend conferences
- How should we as SECAS staff allocate our time to best sustain the value of the partnership?



A model for thinking about staff time



A model for thinking about staff time



- **Support:** Helping people use the products of SECAS (e.g., Blueprint user support)
- **Improve:** Product development and updates (e.g., Blueprint revision)
- **Promote:** Spreading the word with new partners (e.g., giving a webinar)

Raise your hand or put comments in the chat!



Where should SECAS staff focus their time to ensure the partnership remains relevant to your work?

- **Support:** Helping people use the products of SECAS (e.g., Blueprint user support)
- **Improve:** Product development and updates (e.g., Blueprint revision)
- **Promote:** Spreading the word with new partners (e.g., giving a webinar)

Now, let's move to Menti to take a vote!

Looking ahead to this year and next

- Staff are now at the point we are planning to release a Blueprint 2026 this fall with a modest number of Blueprint improvements
- Wrestling with the idea of Blueprint 2026 workshops and how best to solicit feedback with a reduced staff
- Did we get the balance right this year? What's most important to our community moving forward?



Focus of this next section

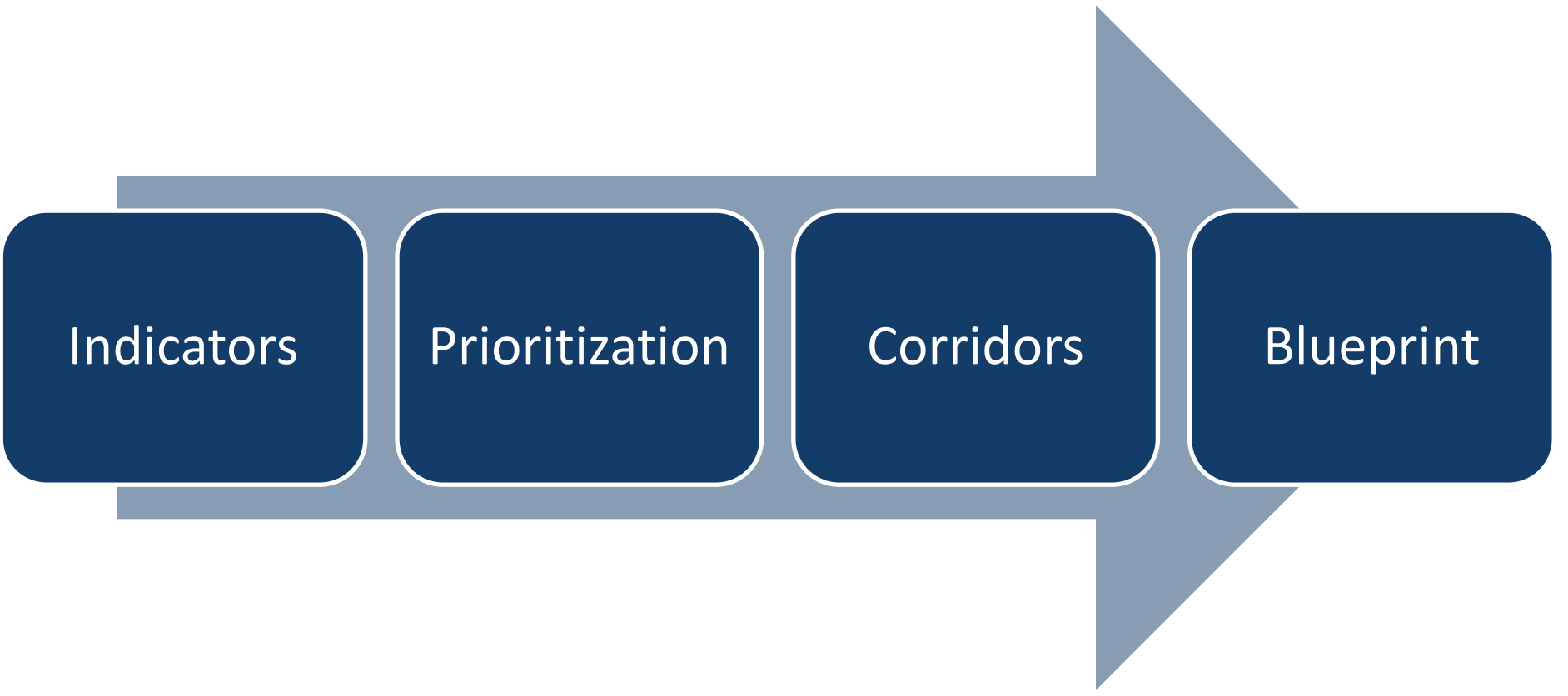
- We want to solicit input on thorny issues that staff have gotten stuck on:
 - How often do we update the Blueprint?
 - How/how often do we ask for feedback on the Blueprint?

A brief tour of the Blueprint sausage factory

- Historically, we have updated the Blueprint annually
- What does that entail?
- At the high end (in 2023)
 - 4 GIS people + 6 user support people
 - As many as 50+ indicators
- At the low end (in 2026)
 - 1 GIS person + 2.5 user support people
 - 5 indicators



Process for developing the Southeast Blueprint



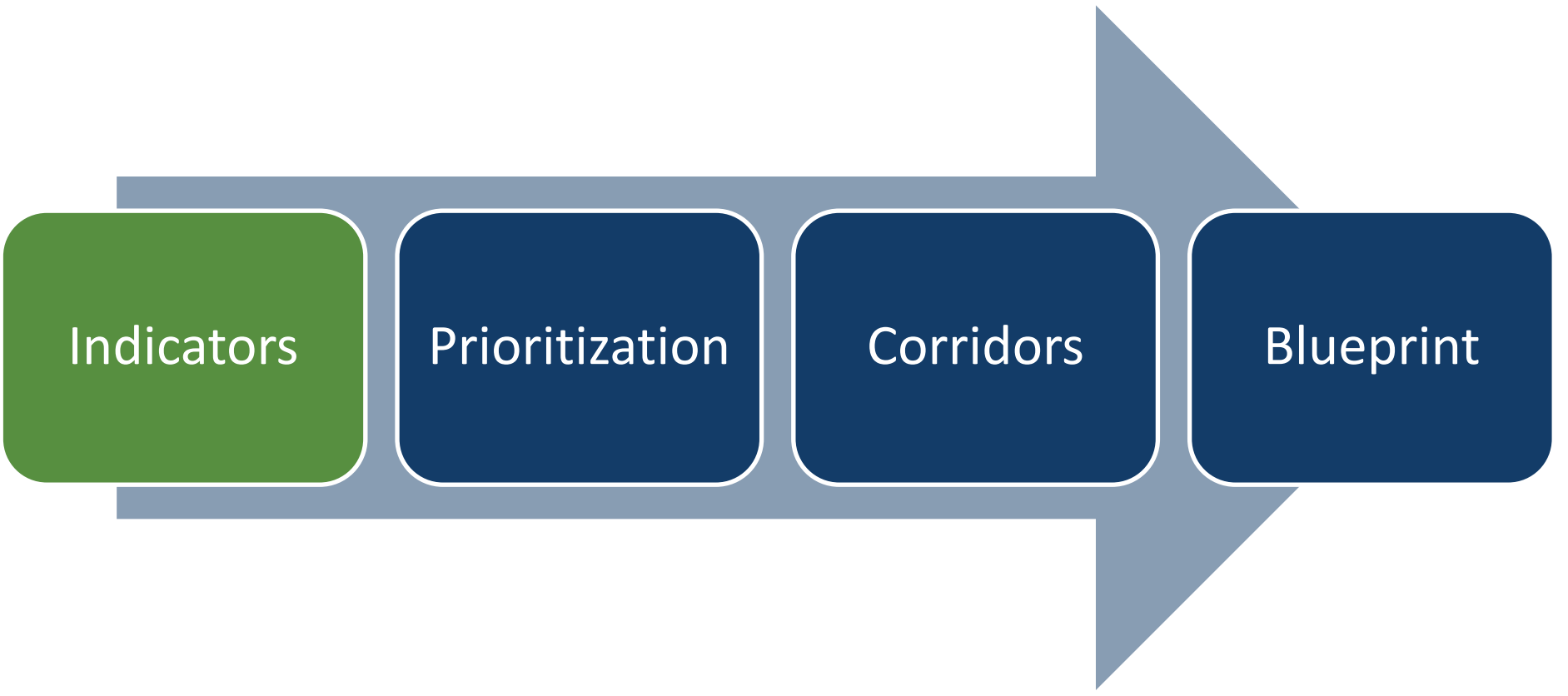
Indicators

Prioritization

Corridors

Blueprint

Process for developing the Southeast Blueprint



Indicators

Prioritization

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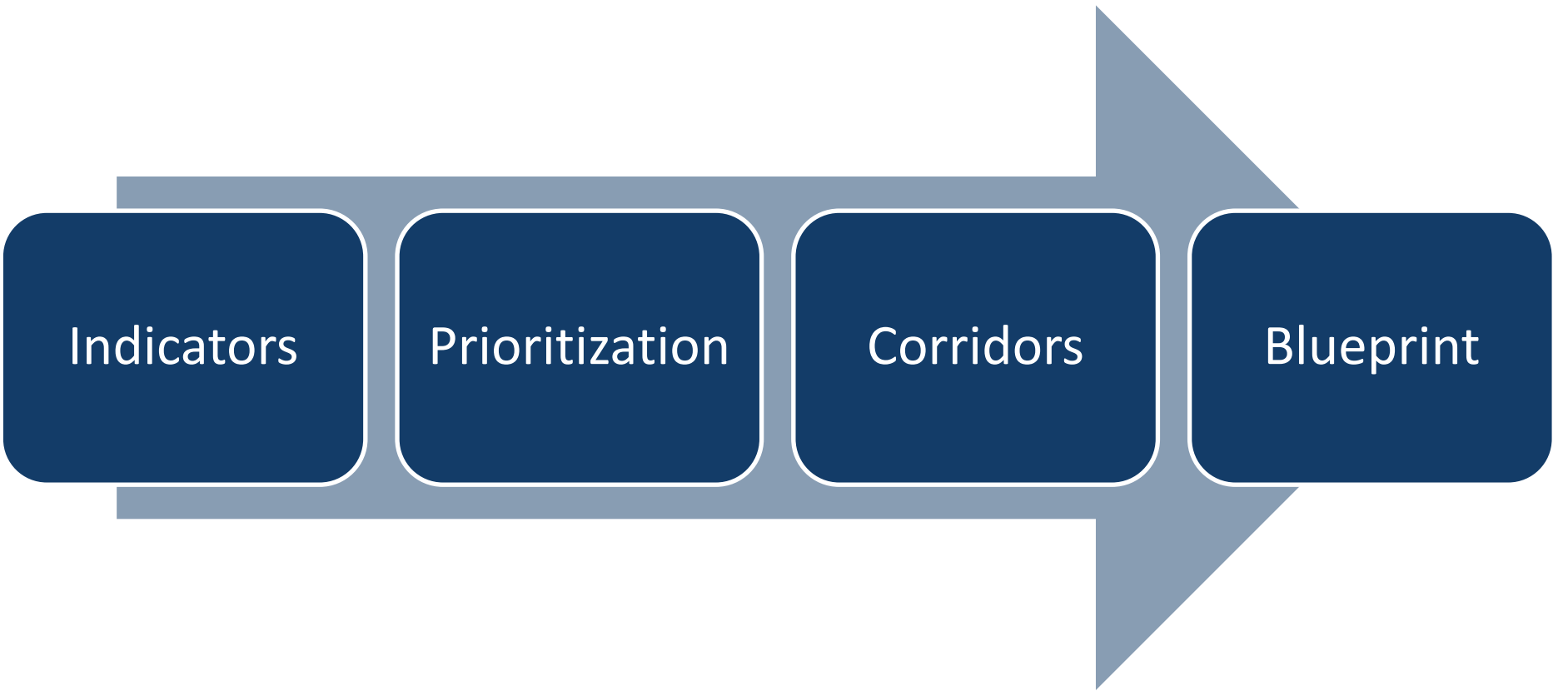
Blueprint

Focus on the indicators

- Indicators: Developing the data building blocks of the Blueprint
- Lasts from December → May
- Here, the amount of staff time required depends on the number of updates we take on



Process for developing the Southeast Blueprint



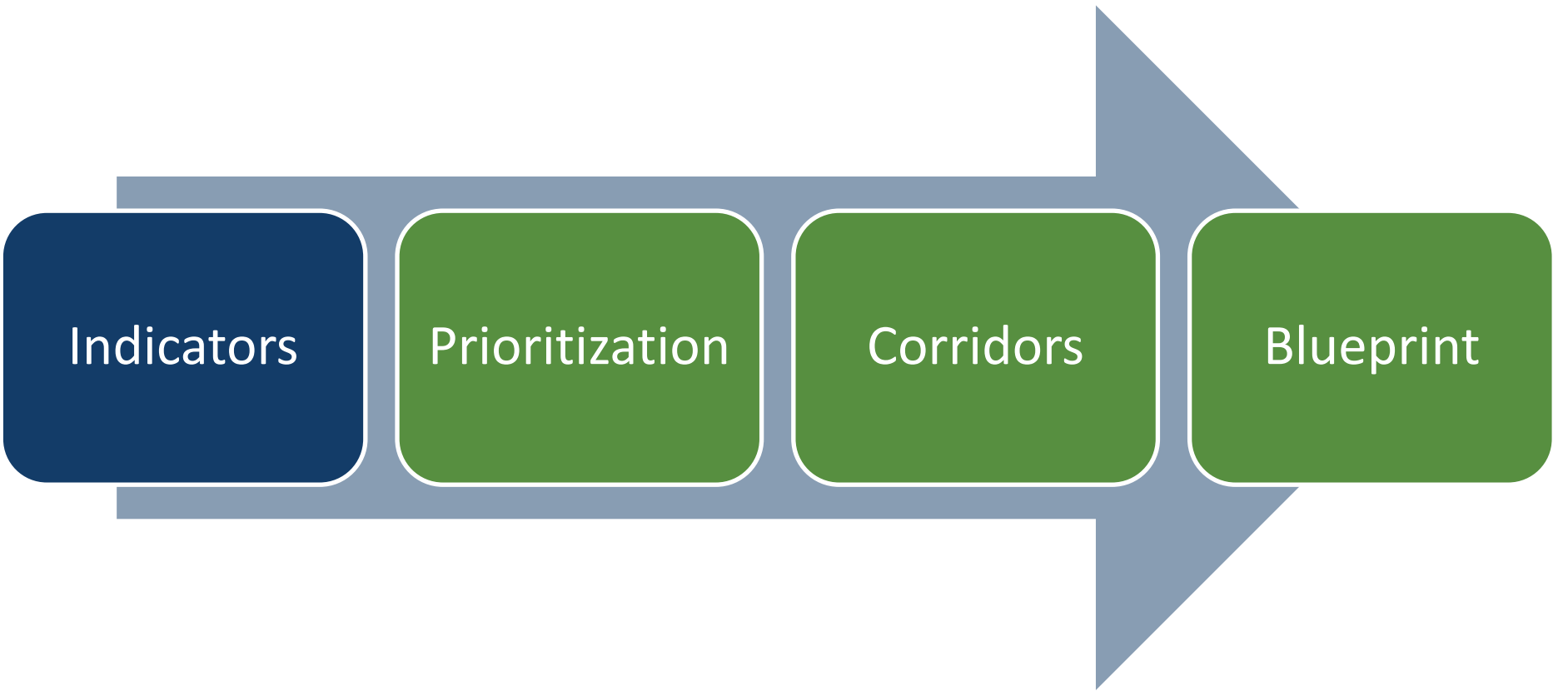
Indicators

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Process for developing the Southeast Blueprint



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graph LR; A[Indicators] --> B[Prioritization]; B --> C[Corridors]; C --> D[Blueprint]
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Indicators

Prioritization

Corridors

Blueprint

Focus on the Blueprint modeling

- Running the Blueprint prioritization and connectivity analysis
- Lasts from June → September, then we start making data available in the viewers
- This essentially takes the same amount of time no matter how many indicators we update
- Think of it like a washing machine



Pros and cons of an annual update cycle

Pros

- Able to pull in new data when it's available
- Keeping up with landscape change
- Able to address user feedback quickly
- Touchpoints with our community builds trust

Cons

- Staff time required/opportunity costs
- Are any users finding the regular updates disruptive?

Other factors we're thinking about

- Knowing in advance when to expect the next version
- Timing of when during the year the Blueprint is released (fall?)
- Scale of change (more frequent tweaks vs. less frequent overhauls)
- Maturity of the Blueprint

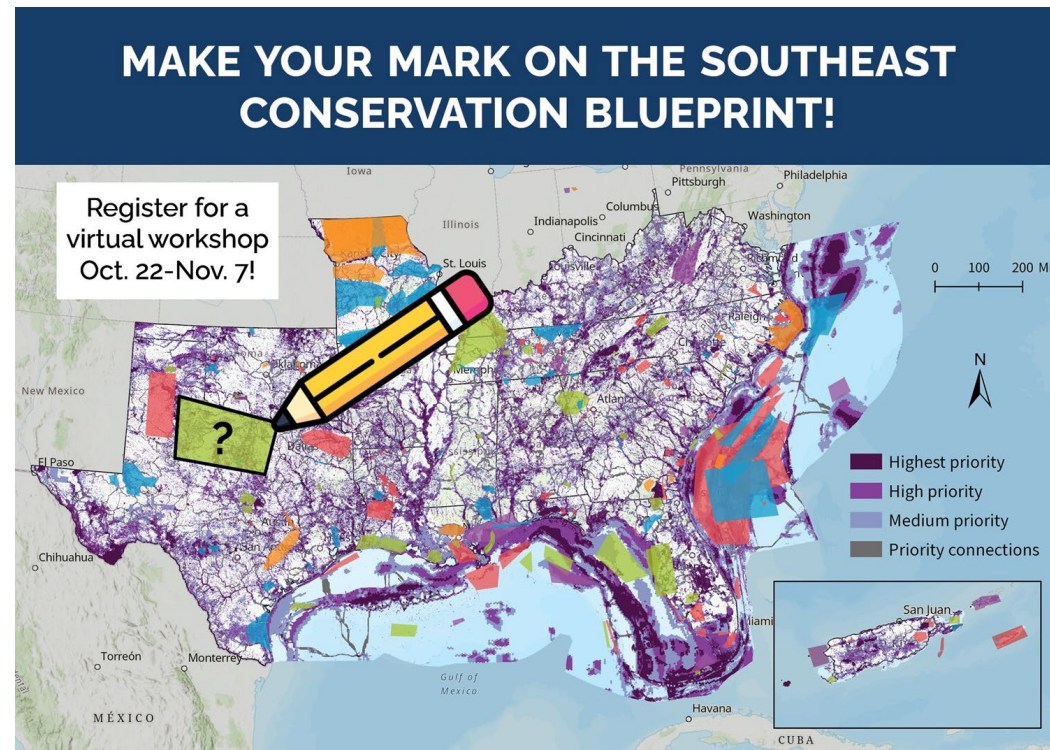
Raise your hand or put comments in the chat!

- What thoughts and feedback would you like to share about the Blueprint revision cycle?

Now, let's move to Menti to take a vote!

Workshops

- Historically, SECAS has hosted workshops to review changes in the Blueprint with most new versions
- No workshops in 2025 due to disruptions
- Last series in 2024:
 - 13 virtual workshops using web feedback tool
 - 176 people from 85 orgs attended
 - Brought in 86 new people and 26 new organizations



Pros and cons of workshops

Pros

- Actionable feedback on priority improvements
- Brings new partners under the SECAS tent
- Deeper learning about the “why”
- Builds trust in the Blueprint and stronger connections with staff

Cons

- Staff time required/opportunity costs
- Are folks experiencing workshop fatigue?
- Do folks feel any frustration if issues they reported the previous cycle still haven't been fixed?

Other factors we're thinking about

- Are workshops the best strategy? What about feedback tools or questionnaires?
- In person vs. virtual
- At what point do people feel overtapped?
- At what point do people lose trust in the Blueprint if they haven't reviewed for awhile?

Raise your hand or put comments in the chat!

- What thoughts and input would you like to share about workshops and other ways of providing Blueprint feedback?

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Raise your hand or put comments in the chat!

- Is there anything else you'd like to share?
- Do you have any questions for the SECAS team?

Next steps

- We'll collate the feedback and share in a blog in an upcoming newsletter
- Staff will strategize on how best to incorporate this feedback in future years



Next Third Thursday
Web Forum

7-16-2026

10:00 am ET

Jacob Blandford

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The Appalachian Mountains: A wildlife highway for climate change adaptation



How to get involved in SECAS

- Sign up for the SECAS newsletter

secassoutheast.org

- Connect with SECAS staff or partners

[secassoutheast.org / staff](https://secassoutheast.org/staff)

[secassoutheast.org / partners](https://secassoutheast.org/partners)

- Explore the Southeast Conservation Blueprint

[secassoutheast.org / blueprint](https://secassoutheast.org/blueprint)



**Southeast
Conservation
Adaptation
Strategy**

Questions?

